

PLAYER REPORT



SEYDOU DEMBÉLÉ

— POSITION:

ATT. MIDFIELDER

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Games Watched:

- Morocco U-17 vs Mali U-17 (AFCON Final Stage)
- **Minutes Watched:** 120 Minutes

Date: 09.06.2026



PLAYER PROFILE

- **Full Name:** Seydou Dembélé
- **Date of Birth:** 16 February 2008
- **Age:** 18 years old (as of 2026)
- **Nationality:** Malian
- **Current Club:** JMG Academy
Bamako
- **National Team:** Mali U-17
- **Position:** Attacking Midfielder

GAME STATS

- Total Games: 1
- Starting XI: 1
- Minutes: 120
- G/A: 0
- Discipline: 0YC

OVERALL SUMMARY

- Seydou Dembélé is a Malian central midfielder known for his creative and dribbling qualities offer a real threat from midfield to opposition sides and his contribution to attack is very good.
- His contribution to attack in this game was significant and he was involved in numerous set piece situations and final third exchanges.
- He demonstrated very good technical quality, a good progressive intent, and was creative with the ball in attacking phases but failed to really consistently break down the very compact Moroccan defence.
- This demonstrated how this was a very creative player with clear attacking intent and ability but lacked control over the phases.



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TECHNICAL ATTRIBUTES

- **Ball Control:** He maintained close control in congested areas and was able to retain possession even under pressure from multiple opponents.
- **Passing:** He delivered clean forward passes and could connect both defensive and attacking lines effectively. His passes were often well-weighted for the next action.
- **Press Resistance:** He showed the ability to evade opponents in 1v1 and 1v2 situations using close control and awareness of space.
- **Free Kick Delivery:** He demonstrated strong free kick technique, delivering accurate and dangerous balls into attacking areas.

MENTALITY ATTRIBUTES

- **Game Intelligence:** Dembélé consistently read the movement of teammates and opponents, allowing him to position himself effectively to receive or intercept passes. He showed strong anticipation in both attacking and defensive phases.
- **Decision Making:** He thought quickly to avoid losing possession and generally chose the correct passing options. He knew when to release the ball and when to retain it, especially in tight central areas.
- **Composure:** He remained calm when pressed, even in congested midfield zones, and rarely panicked when under opponent pressure.
- **Work Rate:** He consistently moved to support play, pressed opponents aggressively, and dominated central areas through constant activity and availability.

TACTICAL ATTRIBUTES

- **Positioning:** He consistently positioned himself in areas where he could receive, progress, or block passing lanes effectively.
- **Off-the-ball Movement:** He constantly made himself available for passes and adjusted his position based on ball location and team shape.
- **Defensive Awareness:** He actively blocked passing lanes, applied pressure intelligently, and disrupted opponent buildup play.
- **Link-up Play:** He effectively connected the backline to forwards, ensuring smooth progression of possession.
- **Spatial Utilization:** He recognized and exploited open areas to receive and distribute the ball efficiently.

PHYSICAL ATTRIBUTES

- **Agility:** He was able to adjust quickly in small spaces, allowing him to escape pressure and maintain possession.
- **Stamina:** He maintained intensity throughout the match, constantly offering passing options and pressing opponents.
- **Strength in Duels:** He showed bravery and effectiveness when challenging taller and stronger players, especially in central battles.



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OFFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

MOVEMENT TO RECEIVE

- **Space Finding:** Always made movement into open central channels to receive when under pressure
- **Timing:** Arrived at the right moments to support buildup play and progression.
- **Body Orientation:** Received predominantly on the half-turn, enabling play facing forward.
- **Availability:** Consistently offered himself as an option in central areas to receive.
- **Proactivity:** Anticipated passing angles and adjusted to position prior to receiving.

BALL RETENTION

- **First Touch:** Remained clean and in a playable area in tight midfield spaces.
- **Pressure Escape:** Able to ride challenges, keep possession when pressured, and evade congestion with close control.
- **Composure:** Calm and assured when under pressure.
- **Decision Safety:** Opted for the safe option, with a focus on retaining possession.
- **Support Awareness:** Showed understanding to play simple combinations with nearest teammates to retain the ball.



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OFFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

BALL PROGRESSION

- **Forward Play:** Moved play forward when opportunity arose and had desire to do so.
- **Line Breaking:** Carried and passed the ball through the lines to advance play.
- **Carry Impact:** Carried the ball forward through the middle to advance possession in transition.
- **Execution Quality:** Most passes and actions were well-weighted and well-timed.
- **Vision:** Noted spaces available to pass through to break lines.

FINAL THIRD IMPACT

- **Forward Runs:** Stepped beyond the half-way line to support forward play.
- **Runs in Behind:** No specific or consistent runs beyond the defensive line were observed, though was aware of it.
- **Box Arrival:** Made infrequent runs into the penalty area and box area.
- **Link with Forwards:** Good connections with the front line and ability to transfer the ball to them.
- **Finishing / Creativity:** Provided a link to creativity in the final third through his passing, not finishing.



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DEFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

DEFENSIVE DUELING

- **1v1 Ability:** Competed well in central duels and kept himself within touching distance of physically stronger opponents.
- **Tackling:** Looked to time challenges more effectively and made more tackles for interceptions and containment rather than driving in.
- **Aerial Duels:** Got into challenges and seemed capable of competing at a reasonable level.
- **Physical Strength:** Could hold his ground when isolated in a central duel.
- **Aggressiveness / Timing:** Picked his moments wisely when to compete.

DYNAMIC PRESSING

- **Press Timing:** Triggered press effectively in the centre and around opposition playing through the middle.
- **Approach Speed:** Was quick in closing down space.
- **Body Control:** Effectively used his body shape to force opponents into non-threatening areas.
- **Disruption:** He blocked passing lanes regularly and disrupted build-up play.
- **Recovery Work:** Was sharp at getting back to cover central areas and maintain team shape.



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DEFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

POSITIONAL DEFENDING

- **Spatial Awareness:** occupied important central areas and restricted opposition movement through the centre.
- **Lane Blocking:** Regularly stopped play going through central corridors.
- **Compactness:** Stayed central to allow others to be positioned wide.
- **Game Reading:** showed an awareness of likely patterns of play.
- **Support Coverage:** Covered for teammates when they moved centrally.

MENTALITY & PHYSICAL OUTPUT

- **Demand Ball:** Was eager to receive the ball and take responsibility in possession.
- **Confidence:** Looked very comfortable on the ball, particularly in the central build-up.
- **Resilience:** Responded well to losing the ball and also to challenges in the centre.
- **Mobility / Work Rate:** Covered significant ground in central areas.
- **Stamina / Recovery:** Remained heavily involved throughout the 90 minutes.



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STRENGTHS

- An outstanding ability to protect and keep hold of the ball under intensity.
- A high level of game intelligence in regards to reading passing lanes and spacing.
- An incredibly strong ability to link defense, midfield and attack together.
- Consistent work ethic and energy to get around the park over the course of 90 minutes.
- Excellent positional awareness and ability to help the shape of the team in defense.
- Good progressive passes and advancement into midfield areas.
- Strong mentality, confidence and belief in his abilities to impose himself.

AREAS FOR IMPROVEMENT

- Limited in terms of final third final product (limited goal/assist input).
- Tendency to play it too safe under pressure in higher areas.
- Physically powerful but still developing against top physical opponents in central midfield.
- Lacks an amount of vertical creativity/risk taking in attack.
- Impact in the decisive final pass/assist/shot has been less evident so far.



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INVESTMENT

- Seydou Dembélé profiles as a valuable development investment at midfield.
- His current strengths in press resistance, ball retention, positioning and progression suggest a player who has already adapted well in disciplined, elite youth systems.
- His final product in the final third, however, is currently weak thus his short-term return is not one of goals and assists but of control, security and buildup.
- His ceiling relies entirely on the attacking risk and final third output that he develops in time.

STRATEGIC FIT

Dembélé is most suited to structured, possession-oriented midfield systems which favor control and progression to pure final third output. These would include:

- Double or single pivot systems where he can manage tempo and circulation
- Possession-oriented systems where stability and build-up are prioritized
- Deep-lying playmaker or central connector type midfield roles
- Systems that favor receiving under pressure and advancing play securely

RECOMMENDATION

- Improve his decision-making, risk-taking in the final third.
- Increase his goal involvement (shots, late runs, final pass volume).
- Further enhance his physique to better hold his own at higher levels of physical competition.
- Solidify and maintain his current strengths in press resistance and positional intelligence.
- Transition him slowly from this defensive oriented role to that of a complete controller with final third impact.